revolutionize its defence policy and seek a role for it in a world challenged by a rising China and a less assertive America. On his maiden trip to Japan in September 2014, Modi wooed Japanese investment by remarking that he had converted Indian red tape into a red carpet while the two countries upgraded their ties to a special strategic global partnership. Tokyo promised to invest US $35 billion in India over the next five years and talks are ongoing about a civil nuclear deal between the two leading Asian nations.[18] On Abe's return visit to India in December 2015, agreements were signed to finalize Japanese companies building India's first bullet train connecting the industrial hubs of Mumbai and Ahmedabad. If Abe is able to change Japan's post–World War II policy restricting sale of defence equipment, India will also be able to purchase Japanese US-2 amphibian aircraft.

Modi's landmark economic programme is the 'Make in India' scheme under which he seeks to balance the desire for economic self-sufficiency with the aspiration of building a world-class economy. The fear of the East India Company's legacy is so deep-rooted that even today most Indian leaders would rather India not be dependent on any country. However, India needs foreign technologies and massive foreign investment if it seeks to become a global economic powerhouse. Modi has invited investment from corporations and businesses in every country. Foreign investors are eager to access India's large market but the drastic changes they expected are yet to be adopted.

India's economy has tremendous potential and there is a huge demographic divided which is waiting to be harnessed. Modi's administration has a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity to build on this by harnessing the Indian and global corporate sectors to spur Indian economic growth. This, however, will require as much attention to the domestic economy as Modi has given to foreign policy. In both spheres, the prime minister has to contend with entrenched views that characterize the Indian bureaucracy's way of thinking as well as the exigencies of domestic